

ZenQMS — Competitive Strategy Brief

How we match them on the essentials and win in our target market | June 2026

Bottom line. ZenQMS is a solid, well-liked eQMS, but it wins on being *simple and human*, not on being *modern*. Its product has known soft spots — sequential (non-collaborative) document review, reporting it had to retrofit, a thin CAPA module, and an AI story that is still mostly "coming soon." Those gaps are our opening. The plan below is short on them and long on us: what we must match to be credible, and where we move to win.

Their position, in one glance

They serve small-to-mid life-sciences teams that have outgrown paper/SharePoint but find the enterprise incumbents too heavy. Their two real strengths are **responsive human support** and **all-users / all-modules pricing** (no per-seat fees). Everything else is competitive ground we can take. Notably, pricing is fully hidden behind a sales demo, and onboarding is a 30–90 day, salesperson-led process.

Where we win

Their weakness	Our move	Why it lands
No real-time document collaboration — reviews are sequential, one signer at a time	Parallel review with inline comments inside a compliant, locked audit trail	This is their single most-repeated user complaint and is unsolved across the whole category
AI is mostly roadmap — only two features shipped, the rest "coming soon"	Ship genuinely useful, audit-safe AI now: change delta-summaries, risk insights, SOP Q&A, CAPA/deviation drafting	We already have working AI summary & risk endpoints — we are ahead here, not catching up
Reporting was historically weak (they only recently added it)	Flexible, role-aware dashboards and reporting out of the box	Closes a gap they spent years getting complaints about
Pricing is opaque and demo-gated; no self-serve	Transparent pricing and lighter, faster onboarding for smaller teams	Removes the friction early-stage buyers feel before they ever see the product
CAPA / issues module admitted to be light	Deeper, more configurable deviation & CAPA workflows	Directly answers a stated limitation in their core quality module

What we must match first (table stakes)

These are non-negotiable for any life-sciences buyer. We cannot win on UX or AI until we clear this bar — it is the price of being taken seriously.

- HAVE** 21 CFR Part 11 / Annex 11 e-signatures with an immutable audit trail (our signature-certificate and audit model already aligns).

- **HAVE** Connected modules — documents, training, change control, issues all link together (our model already does this).
- **BUILD** A free, fast validation package (IQ/OQ/PQ, UAT templates, Part 11 checklist). They use this as a cheap, powerful sales lubricant — we should too.
- **BUILD** Security posture buyers ask for: SOC 2 Type II and ISO 27001 on the roadmap, with a public trust/status page.

What this means for us — the plan

Near term — lead with what already separates us

- Turn our existing AI (delta-summaries, risk insights) into a visible, front-and-centre selling point while they are still promising theirs.
- Design document review as collaborative/parallel from the start — make it the demo moment that exposes their sequential model.

Mid term — remove their reasons to win

- Ship strong reporting and a deeper CAPA/issues workflow so the two product objections disappear.
- Produce the validation package and stand up the trust/compliance page.

Go-to-market — pick a different fight

- Target the smaller / early-stage teams who find even their sales-led, demo-gated process heavy — compete with transparency and self-serve onboarding.
- Do not try to out-support a company whose whole reputation is support. Match it; win on product and AI.

The one-line strategy: they are simple-but-dated; we are simple-and-modern. We match them on compliance and connected workflows, then beat them on collaboration, real shipped AI, and an honest, low-friction buying experience — aimed squarely at the lean teams they make work too hard to buy.